

TOPIC 7: COLOUR APPLICATION IN CRAFTS

1. Colour Production for Crafts

Colours for crafts may come from commercial paints, inks and dyes, or from local natural dyes (leaves, bark, indigo, clay). Prepare colours safely and test them on a sample before applying to the main work.

2. Application of Colour in Craft Works

- Painting on pottery, wood or paper
- Dyeing fabrics (tie-and-dye, batik, immersion dyeing)
- Colouring beads, leather and raffia
- Using coloured threads in weaving and embroidery

Apply colour evenly or in planned patterns; allow drying time; fix dyes so they do not run.

3. Why We Apply Colours on Crafts

- To make objects more attractive and marketable
- To express culture, identity and symbolism
- To highlight form and pattern
- To protect surfaces (in some cases, e.g. varnish with colour)
- To create variety and interest in a set of similar objects

4. Summary

Colour application turns plain craft materials into finished, appealing products. Skill in producing and applying colour adds value to traditional and modern crafts.

End of Topic 7